

INFO 2950 Project: Phase 1

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Git repository link: https://github.com/RamirezDevOps/info2950_data_project

3 potentials data sets:

- Kalshi 2026 - “Texas Senate winner?”
 - **Description:** The Kalshi data set includes prediction markets that focus on elections. The data has rows for market prices/probability, and date that corresponds to columns of its respective candidate. For example, the Kalshi page sourced below contains the market for the 2026 Texas Senate Election, with the candidate name, and their respective market percentages.
 - **Data source:** The main source would be the Kalshi REST API, from which we will collect the data via Python. Kalshi provides a public API, that does not need authentication or an API Key, with public market-data endpoints. The API also supports pagination, so we will be able to aggregate a large number of markets rather than only the example above. [Example market site in Kalshi for the 2026 “Texas Senate winner?”](#). Additionally, [linked here is the Kalshi REST API documentation](#).
 - **Trustworthiness:** This prediction market data is generated from the collective beliefs of market participants. We trust this data because it acts as a primary source of what this prediction market forecast about the result of the Texas Senate election. Since this data is mathematically produced from individual bets, the data does not necessarily need to be checked for quality or accuracy for our analytical purposes. That said, the quality and accuracy of our analysis can be improved by corroborating this source with other prediction markets.
- Votehub
 - **Description:** Votehub is a political media organization that provides coverage in election reporting in a detailed level and real time, and public opinion survey aggregations. They have a simple REST API to GET poll results based on identifying information like poll type, pollster, subject, dates, and sample population. This will help us aggregate polls for the elections and compare them for the Kalshi API data.
 - **Data source:** The main source would be the VoteHub Polling API, from which we will collect the data via Python. VoteHub provides a public API, that does not need authentication or an API Key, with aggregated polls per election. [This is the API documentation site, with examples of how to utilize it and the type of data available](#).

- **Trustworthiness:** This aggregated polling data is found by adding publicly released polls from polling organizations and weighing them on quality and recency. We trust this data because it is derived from 280+ pollsters, and Votehub weighs reputable pollsters such as Emerson College, Gallup, YouGov, and Ipsos higher than other types of polls. We checked the quality of the data by comparing the recent polls displayed by Votehub with the New York Times polltracker (which is reputable given its association with the news site). My specific example was the 2026 Texas Senate General Election, and I found that both Votehub and NYT polltracker highlighted the same ReconMR/Siena Research Institute, Emerson College, and InsiderAdvantage polls as the most recent and reliable polls. The fact that both sources of data point to the same polls dispels the worry that Votehub is selectively choosing polls and producing faulty data. As for the data's accuracy, I do not have qualms about it due to it being derived from many different reliable pollsters. In addition, it is data trusted by the New York Times polltracker - which further boosts its credibility.
- AP 2026 election results
 - **Description:** The AP 2026 elections results is a website, where they will display the election results of the data we will be working with. It would be remiss to not point out that this data does not exist yet, and will be determined after the November 3rd elections. This data will be used to add final clarity to the comparisons between the polls and prediction market.
 - **Data source:** The main source will be the AP 2026 election results webpage. We will be webscrapping this page once the results have been posted by the Associated Press. This page does not have any paywalls or authentication requirements, and will be able to be selected easily via table elements in the HTML. [This is the webpage by The Associated Press we will use once updated with results.](#)
 - **Trustworthiness:** AP collects vote results from voting precincts and county election offices. We trust this source because it is the general standard as to the result of an election; further, it uses a network of on-the-ground local journalists to verify county-by-county results. Given that AP already checks and double-checks its data for quality, we are not worried about extracting faulty data. Its accuracy is trusted by every major news organization; thus we have no qualms about its accuracy either.

Questions for reviewers:

1. Given that prediction markets often have an erratic profile (jolting upward and downward rapidly), is there a particular type of regression/mode of analysis that you recommend that we use to compare it with polling data?

2. Our Votehub dataset provides information on House and Senate races. Would analyzing polling trends across both U.S. Senate *and* House races add some useful variation to our project, or would analyzing both be too redundant?
3. The midterm general election data is relatively simple, but it will only be accessible on Nov. 3 after the midterm elections are decided. Are there any drawbacks or pitfalls that we must be aware of when dealing with data that only is accessible at a later date?